

MANUALLY OPERATED REPEATING RIFLES (1917–45)

The experience of World War I had severely tested military rifles in service throughout the world. Most had stood up to combat conditions well, and when World War II loomed, most rifles still had the bolt-action mechanism recognizable from 50 years before. While the barrels of many had been reduced in length to make rifles lighter and handier, this had little adverse effect on their accuracy over fighting distances.

